

Claudio Maccone

Outgoing Chair, IAA SETI Permanent Committee Chair for nine years: 2012-2021.

REPORT for the Committee Online Meeting held on October 27, 2021.

- 1) The IAA SETI Committee was created by the IAA around 1970. Chairs were Rudolf Pesek, John Billingham, Jill Tarter, Seth Shostak, Claudio Maccone and now Mike Garrett. Key figures were Frank Drake, Josif Shlovskii, Nikolai Kardashev, Carl Sagan and Jean Heidmann. Important, in those early days, were also Dan Werthimer, Ivan Almar, Paul Such and others, spreading the new ideas of SETI worldwide, and making SETI to be recognized as a SCIENCE.
- 2) The IAA SETI Permanent Committee is the only worldwide association of SETI scientists. We contribute to all aspects of SETI: 1) Observational at both radio and optical frequencies, and 2) Theoretical about the many impacts that the discovery of an ExtraTerrestrial Civilization would have on Humankind, including the social, philosophical and political aspects.
- 3) Being the only worldwide SETI association, the IAA SETI Committee should become the world cultural center preparing Humanity for Contact. This was the intendment of chair Maccone who promoted SETI Conferences and Seminars worldwide in conjunction with the International Astronautical Congresses (IACs):

64th	September 23–27, 2013	 Beijing, China
65th	September 29 – October 3, 2014	 Toronto, Canada
66th	October 12–16, 2015	 Jerusalem, Israel
67th	September 26–30, 2016 ^[4]	 Guadalajara, Mexico
68th	September 25–29, 2017 ^[5]	 Adelaide, Australia
69th	October 1–5, 2018	 Bremen, Germany

70th	October 21–25, 2019	 Washington DC, USA
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- 4) Since 2012, the chair Maccone, with the support of the Berkeley SETI Group, did raise the number of SETI Committee Members from about 20 back in 2012 to about 100 now in 2021. Many distinguished SETI Scientists and many young SETI scientists form the Committee nowadays. That was possible since it is NOT necessary to be an IAA Member to join the SETI Committee. However, bona-fide dedication to SETI Research is requested to all Members.
- 5) Breakthrough Listen is a project to search for intelligent extraterrestrial communications in the Universe. With \$100 million in funding and thousands of hours of dedicated telescope time on state-of-the-art facilities, it is the most comprehensive search for alien communications to date. The project began in January 2016, and is expected to continue for 10 years. It is a component of Yuri Milner's Breakthrough Initiatives program. The science program for Breakthrough Listen is based at Berkeley SETI Research Center, located in the Astronomy Department at the University of California, Berkeley. ONE PETABYTE OF DATA IS NOW AVAILABLE FOR DATA MINING.
- 6) Now about UFOs. Up to about 2020, UFO phenomena were left OUTSIDE the interest of the SETI PC. Chairs John Billingham, Jill Tarter, Seth Shostak and Claudio Maccone did all do so.
- 7) However, since the Pentagon acknowledged sightings that could not be explained (2020), the IAA SETI Committee seems to face profound changes in its mission, reflected by corresponding changes in the Terms of Reference.
- 8) Precisely this point led chair Maccone to resign from the position of Chair on June 11, 2021.
- 9) Maccone's **personal opinions** are:
- 10) ExtraTerrestrial Civilizations exist in this galaxy and possibly not too far away from us.
- 11) They know about us but we don't know about them (yet).
- 12) From time to time, they come close to us to keep an eye, and that explains the UFO sightings.

- 13) They do so to CHECK whether we have become MORE MATURE, so mature that they would then admit us to the Galactic Club.
- 14) Maccone's opinion is that, because of the above uncertain situation, the best we can do now is to create a MATHEMATICAL MODEL explaining the evolution of life and intelligence on Earth over the last four billion years. Then we can EXTRAPOLATE from our past into the future of exoplanets, since the future for us may be the past for others. And so try to foresee which parts of this and other galaxies is better to explore first.
- 15) This MATHEMATICAL MODEL was published by Maccone in February 2021 in his book "EVO-SETI: Life Evolution Statistics on Earth and Exoplanets". [Evo-SETI | SpringerLink](#). The mathematics in the book is difficult and based on lognormal probability distributions and stochastic process called "Geometric Brownian Motions" (GBMs). Shannon's Information Theory leads then to the new notion of Evo-Entropy (Entropy of the Evolution of Life) and so this book is a MATHEMATICAL ASTROBIOLOGY book. The existence of the Molecular Clock is derived mathematically and a SCALE FOR LIFE IN THE UNIVERSE is derived also.
- 16) Apart from Evo-SETI mathematical research, Maccone devotes himself also to the MOON FARSIDE LEGAL PROTECTION. This is POLITICS at the United Nations level, to save the Earth and the Moon Farside from POLLUTERS who act for their profit only, and against Astronomy done from the Earth and the Moon. It is URGENT to reach some kind of International Agreement at the United Nations COPUOS before POLLUTERS POLLUTE the Moon also.

Sincerely,

Claudio Maccone

Turin (Italy), October 27, 2021.

[Claudio Maccone - Wikipedia](#)